ESTHER WANJIRU KUNG'U

+254 742 987 208 | wanjirukungu2022@gmail.com | LinkedIn | GitHub | Nairobi, Kenya

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with two years building and running production services in Go and Python on a distributed, microservices architecture. Designs REST APIs and PostgreSQL schemas, secures them with RBAC, and makes them fast through caching and systematic debugging. Comfortable owning a service from code to production, with hands-on Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD and monitoring experience, and used to code review and delivery across time zones.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer & Team Lead | Obmondo (Denmark, remote) *Aug 2024 – Aug 2026*

Features Team: designing and implementing new capabilities for LinuxAid (Linux ops toolkit) and KubeAid (Kubernetes automation and management).

- Developed, maintained, and supported backend services across 5+ production applications, including a custom monitoring and alert management service, in Go and Python on a microservices architecture.
- Designed REST APIs and integrated them with internal systems and third-party services; designed PostgreSQL and MySQL schemas and data access, including bulk endpoints that avoid N+1 queries.
- Designed the authentication and authorization (RBAC) layer securing 10,000+ user sessions, and rolled out Keycloak SSO to centralize identity and access.
- Optimized backend performance: caching with Redis, Memcached, and Cloudflare CDN cut API response times by 35% and page load times by 40%; resolved 50+ production issues through systematic debugging.
- Wrote end-to-end and unit tests (85%+ coverage), reviewed code daily, and maintained documentation and runbooks for a team across Denmark, Argentina, India, and Kenya.
- Shipped services in Docker through GitHub Actions and ArgoCD for zero-downtime releases, and handled alerts across 200+ Linux servers and 50+ production Kubernetes clusters.

Presales Solutions Architect (Intern) | Airtel Africa *May 2024 – Jul 2024*

- Analyzed data and built reports and dashboards in Power BI and Tableau for Airtel Kenya's Enterprise Business (B2B) team, supporting solution proposals for business customers.

Software Engineering Intern | OneKitty (Hybrid) *Jan 2023 – Dec 2023*

- Built and maintained Spring Boot microservices for a contribution and fundraising platform, improving service reliability by 25%.
- Worked on PHP services alongside the Java stack and added regression tests to catch issues before release.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science (Software Engineering), Second Class Upper Honours, St Paul's University | 2022 – 2024
Diploma in International Relations, Merit, Strathmore University | 2019 – 2021

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, Bash, SQL
Backend: REST APIs, microservices, authentication and RBAC, Keycloak SSO, Spring Boot
Data: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Memcached
Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, ArgoCD, GitHub Actions, Gitea Actions, Terraform, Crossplane, AWS, Hetzner
Observability: Prometheus, alerting, incident response, root cause analysis

CERTIFICATIONS & LEADERSHIP

Founder: NiaTalent (niatalent.com), a platform that assesses African talent through real work simulations and places them with companies worldwide
Certifications: Google Project Management; Google Data Analytics; AWS Certified Solutions Architect, Associate (in progress)
Leadership: Chair, Youth Innovation & Future Technologies Council, MATA (Marketers Accelerating Trade in Africa), since Aug 2025